

Quantum Change Intervals: Exact Asymptotic Localization with Collective Measurements

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We consider exact minimum-error localization of a transient change in a sequence of independent pure-state outputs. The source emits $|0\rangle$, switches abruptly to a calibrated state $|\psi\rangle$ on one nonempty contiguous interval, and then returns perfectly to $|0\rangle$. The outputs may be stored coherently and measured collectively. For a known interval length i , the candidate-state Gram matrix is $G_{ab} = r^{\min(|a-b|, i)}$, where $r = |\langle 0|\psi\rangle|^2$. For each fixed i , its Toeplitz symbol gives an exact integral for the asymptotic Bayes success probability, and the square-root measurement (SRM) attains the same limit. When both the known length and the number of admissible translations diverge, with no restriction on their ratio, the optimum approaches the single-change-point law $p_1(|\langle 0|\psi\rangle|^2)$. For an unknown length, the physical Gram kernel is not globally two-dimensional Toeplitz because separated intervals carry a gap-dependent correction. Under the prior uniform over all nonempty intervals, we remove a vanishing-prior short sector, use a triangular Følner reduction, and transfer the result back to both the Bayes optimum and the SRM of the full physical family. The resulting, prior-specific limit is $p_1(c)^2$, where $c = |\langle 0|\psi\rangle|$. Adding a no-change hypothesis with fixed prior preserves these conditional localization laws. Finite-size semidefinite programs and full dense physical-Gram SRM computations illustrate the asymptotic results.

Keywords: quantum change point; quantum state discrimination; change interval; square-root measurement; Toeplitz operator; Følner sequence; Bayesian detection

1 Introduction

Quantum change-point inference asks where an ordered source changes from one state-generating process to another. Unlike a classical observer, the receiver may retain the systems and measure the entire sequence collectively. Early Bayesian work considered

unknown pure states and two possible change locations [1]. For a single permanent change, collective minimum-error discrimination has a nonzero asymptotic success probability and can outperform online local strategies [2]; exact and online unambiguous-identification protocols were subsequently developed in Refs. [3, 4]. An adaptive Bayesian online protocol was also demonstrated experimentally with photonic state sequences [5]. Separate formulations optimize different operational risks. Quickest and sequential quantum change detection trade false-alarm control against detection delay [6, 7]. Hamiltonian change points are finite-candidate quantum process-discrimination problems under a minimum-error criterion [8], whereas the 2026 channel result studies unambiguous process discrimination and hence permits an inconclusive outcome [9]. The literature also includes general Gram-matrix semidefinite programs, multiple changes, isolated anomalies, and boundaries between quantum domains [10–13].

Here the change is transient: the source returns to its reference state after one nonempty contiguous anomalous block. We refer to this interval-constrained family as a *quantum change interval*. For a sequence of length n and an interval $I = [a, b]$, the corresponding hypothesis is

$$|\Phi_{a,b}\rangle = |0\rangle^{\otimes(a-1)}|\psi\rangle^{\otimes(b-a+1)}|0\rangle^{\otimes(n-b)}.$$

When the length $i = b - a + 1$ is known, only the translation a is inferred; when the length is unknown, both endpoints are inferred. Figure 1 summarizes this returning geometry and the collective exact-localization task.

The model is related to established quantum tasks through several precise restrictions. The boundary slice $b = n$ is the permanent quantum change-point family [2–4]. A general multiple-change-point framework contains it as the constrained pattern $|0\rangle \rightarrow |\psi\rangle \rightarrow |0\rangle$ [10]. For fixed length i , the candidates form the strict subensemble of the $k = i$ multi-anomaly problem in which the anomalous sites are consecutive; the unknown-length family is the union of these contiguous subensembles over i [12]. Quantum edge detection instead locates a single boundary between domains whose pure states are unknown and proves an SRM-based protocol asymptotically optimal [13].

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It is therefore a single-boundary geometric analogue, not a prior-preserving supermodel of the present task. Here two endpoints are tied to one interval, the two local states are calibrated and known, and both exterior domains are fixed to the same reference state $|0\rangle$.

The unknown-length problem has a specific obstruction that is hidden by the two-endpoint notation. For intersecting intervals, the overlap kernel depends only on the endpoint displacement and agrees with a separable two-dimensional Toeplitz kernel. For separated intervals, however, the physical overlap contains an additional correction determined by the gap between the two intervals. Thus the exact physical Gram matrix is neither a global two-dimensional Toeplitz compression nor an element of a transitive association scheme. A direct multilevel Szegő theorem therefore does not solve the problem. The proof deletes a short-interval sector whose prior mass vanishes, compares the retained long-interval Gram matrix in operator norm with a separable convolution kernel on a triangular Følner sequence, and obtains matching SRM and optimum limits through local-diagonal functional calculus and a Gram upper bound. A prior-mass sandwich transfers the optimum to all intervals, while principal-submatrix interlacing, including the essential retained-family factor, transfers the square-root trace and hence the SRM of the full physical family.

Throughout this paper, *exact localization* refers to the zero-one reward: an outcome is successful only when the reported interval $\hat{I}$ equals the true interval I . The minimum-error POVM has one reported interval for every outcome and may make an incorrect report. This is different from *unambiguous exact identification*, where every conclusive report must be correct, the cross-errors are constrained to zero, and an additional inconclusive outcome is allowed [3, 12]. The present paper studies the former criterion, including when a no-anomaly hypothesis is added.

One operational setting is a batch of quantum probes or carriers emitted by a device during a transient coherent disturbance. The model assumes independent single-system outputs, a calibrated pure anomalous state $|\psi\rangle$, an abrupt switch from $|0\rangle$, a state that remains constant throughout the anomalous block, and a perfect return to $|0\rangle$. A receiver may retain the complete batch coherently and apply an unrestricted global POVM to estimate the onset and duration. We treat this as an ultimate collective-measurement benchmark. Correlated or mixed outputs, gradual switching, imperfect recovery, unknown fault states, and restricted storage or readout architectures require different models.

The same returning geometry appears in classical statistics. Epidemic alternatives and changed-segment models place a temporary distributional change on an unknown contiguous interval [14, 15], while scan methods cover spatial or graph-structured

changed regions [16, 17]. Those works optimize classical test statistics and type-I-error or power criteria. Here the observations are noncommuting quantum hypotheses, arbitrary collective POVMs are allowed, and the target is the exact Bayes localization probability. Table 1 summarizes the resulting distinctions.

We use *quantum change interval* as a descriptive name for this returning contiguous ensemble. It remains a restricted instance of multiple quantum change points and anomalous-site identification, and is distinct from the unknown-state boundary problem in quantum edge detection. Standard Toeplitz and circulant asymptotics, including multilevel spectral-distribution theorems, provide the matrix-analytic background [18–20]. Asymptotic SRM optimality by itself is not unique to this setting: it is already established for quantum edge detection [13]. The contribution here is the combination of exact asymptotic Bayes laws for the interval ensemble, a Toeplitz/Følner reduction that handles a physical kernel which is not globally two-dimensional Toeplitz, and a transfer proving asymptotic optimality for the SRM of the full, untruncated physical family. More precisely:

1. For fixed known length i , the optimal and SRM success probabilities converge to a one-dimensional Toeplitz integral, with an $O(N^{-1/2})$ bound on their difference.
2. If $i = i_n \rightarrow \infty$ and the number $N_n = n - i_n + 1$ of admissible translations also diverges, both probabilities converge to $p_1(c^2)$, with no assumption on i_n/N_n .
3. Under the prior uniform on all nonempty intervals, both probabilities converge to $p_1(c)^2$. This law is tied to that interval prior and is not asserted for arbitrary priors on the unknown length. The change from $p_1(c^2)$ to $p_1(c)^2$ reflects both the replacement of one translation coordinate by two endpoint coordinates and the change of the elementary overlap parameter from c^2 to c .
4. If the no-anomaly prior $\pi_0 \in (0, 1)$ is fixed and the conditional localization limit is L , the joint detection-and-localization success probability converges to $\pi_0 + (1 - \pi_0)L$.

The endpoint cases $c = 0, 1$ are treated separately. Throughout, the source outputs are independent, the switching is abrupt, and the anomalous block has a fixed calibrated pure state before a perfect return to $|0\rangle$. The overlap c is independent of n ; when H_0 is present, $\pi_0 \in (0, 1)$ is likewise independent of n . The location or interval has the stated uniform prior, and coherent storage followed by an arbitrary collective POVM is allowed. We consider one anomalous interval; local asymptotic alternatives $c = c_n \rightarrow 1$, unknown states, measurement restrictions, and multiple disjoint intervals are outside the scope of the results below.

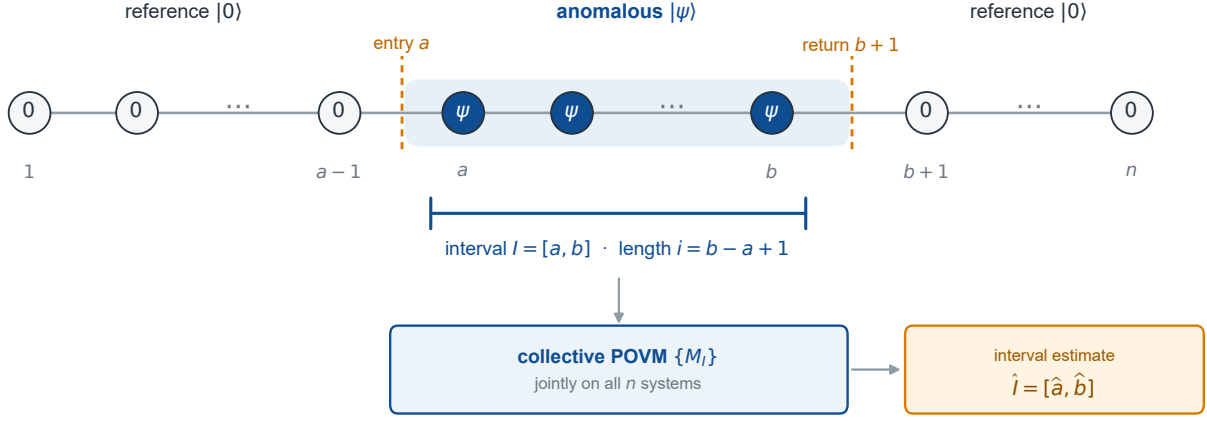


Figure 1: **Returning quantum change interval and collective localization.** A source emits the reference state $|0\rangle$ except on a nonempty contiguous interval $I = [a, b]$, where it emits the known anomalous state $|\psi\rangle$. The entry and return boundaries are a and $b + 1$, respectively. For known length, $i = b - a + 1$ is fixed and only a is inferred; for unknown length, both endpoints are inferred. An arbitrary collective POVM may act on all n systems and returns an exact interval estimate $\hat{I}$.

Table 1: Theorem-level comparison and structural relations between quantum change intervals and neighboring quantum and classical models.

Work	Relation to change intervals	Established result	Difference addressed here
Sentís et al. [2–4]	Exactly the boundary slice $b = n$	Minimum-error permanent-change limit; separate finite-size unambiguous-identification laws and online protocols	A returning interval couples entry and return boundaries under the minimum-error criterion
Mohan–Sikora–Upadhyay [10]	Contains this model as a constrained two-change-point instance	Their Theorem 2.1 gives an exact Gram-only SDP for general Bayes rewards; Appendix D gives a sectorwise two-change Gram kernel and finite SDP/heuristic calculations	No closed $n \rightarrow \infty$ interval law or SRM-optimality theorem for the returning subfamily
Quantum multi-anomaly detection [12]	For fixed i , contains the interval candidates as the consecutive $k = i$ subensemble	Johnson symmetry gives exact finite- n SRM optimality and a closed spectral formula; for fixed k , $P_{\text{opt}} = (1 - c^2)^k + O(n^{-1/2})$, plus a zero-error program	The consecutive-subset restriction destroys Johnson transitivity and requires Toeplitz/Følner reductions
Quantum edge detection [13]	Single-boundary geometric analogue, not a prior-preserving containment relation	Schur–Weyl and SDP analysis for unknown pure-state domains; an SRM protocol is asymptotically optimal	Here two tied endpoints delimit one interval, the states are known, the exterior domains equal $ 0\rangle$, and the full physical Gram kernel requires a non-Toeplitz-to-Følner transfer
Epidemic/changed-interval statistics [14–17]	Direct classical analogue of the returning interval	Scan/CUSUM detection, significance, and power guarantees for commuting data	The quantum problem optimizes exact Bayes localization over collective POVMs

2 Model and discrimination preliminaries

2.1 Phase convention and Gram matrices

Write

$$\langle 0|\psi\rangle = ce^{i\varphi}, \quad 0 \leq c \leq 1, \quad r = c^2.$$

Replacing $|\psi\rangle$ by $e^{-i\varphi}|\psi\rangle$ changes each candidate vector only by a hypothesis-dependent global phase. Equivalently, the original and phase-fixed Gram matrices are related by a diagonal unitary conjugation. Minimum-error and SRM success probabilities are unchanged. We therefore use

$$\langle 0|\psi\rangle = c \geq 0$$

without loss of generality.

Unless a theorem explicitly introduces a sequence $i = i_n$, every asymptotic statement is taken as $n \rightarrow \infty$ with c (and hence $r = c^2$) fixed. In Section 6, the no-anomaly prior $\pi_0 \in (0, 1)$ is also fixed rather than scaled with n .

For an ensemble of M normalized pure states $\{|\phi_j\rangle\}_{j=1}^M$ with equal priors, let

$$G_{jk} = \langle \phi_j | \phi_k \rangle.$$

We write $P_{\text{opt}}(G)$ for the minimum-error optimum over all POVMs [21–24] and

$$P_{\text{SRM}}(G) = \frac{1}{M} \sum_{j=1}^M (\sqrt{G})_{jj}^2$$

for the square-root-measurement success probability [25–27]. If G is singular, $G^{-1/2}$ is understood on

the support of G , and the POVM is completed arbitrarily on its orthogonal complement; this does not change any ensemble success probability. The elementary trace bound

$$\left(\frac{\text{tr} \sqrt{G}}{M}\right)^2 \leq P_{\text{SRM}}(G) \leq P_{\text{opt}}(G) \quad (2.1)$$

will be used repeatedly.

2.2 Stability under Gram perturbations

Lemma 2.1 (Operator-norm Gram stability). *Let $G, H \in \mathbb{C}^{M \times M}$ be positive semidefinite with unit diagonal. Then*

$$|P_{\text{opt}}(G) - P_{\text{opt}}(H)| \leq \|\sqrt{G} - \sqrt{H}\|_{\text{op}} \leq \|G - H\|_{\text{op}}^{1/2} \quad (2.2)$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} |P_{\text{SRM}}(G) - P_{\text{SRM}}(H)| \\ \leq 2\|\sqrt{G} - \sqrt{H}\|_{\text{op}} \leq 2\|G - H\|_{\text{op}}^{1/2}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.3)$$

If $G, H \geq \mu I$ for some $\mu > 0$, then

$$\|\sqrt{G} - \sqrt{H}\|_{\text{op}} \leq \frac{\|G - H\|_{\text{op}}}{2\sqrt{\mu}}. \quad (2.4)$$

Proof. Use the canonical Gram realizations $|x_j\rangle = \sqrt{G}e_j$ and $|y_j\rangle = \sqrt{H}e_j$. Their norms are one because the Gram matrices have unit diagonal, and the trace distance between the corresponding pure states is at most $\|x_j - y_j\|$. Apply an optimal POVM for either ensemble to the other and average over j to obtain the first inequality in (2.2). The second is the operator Hölder inequality for positive square roots. Since $0 \leq (\sqrt{G})_{jj}, (\sqrt{H})_{jj} \leq 1$, the scalar bound $|a^2 - b^2| \leq 2|a - b|$ gives (2.3). For the final claim, $X = \sqrt{G} - \sqrt{H}$ solves

$$\sqrt{G}X + X\sqrt{H} = G - H.$$

The inverse Sylvester operator has norm at most $(2\sqrt{\mu})^{-1}$, which proves (2.4). $\square$

3 A known interval length

Let the anomalous interval have known length $i \geq 1$. There are

$$N = n - i + 1$$

admissible starting points, and the equal-prior candidates are

$$\begin{aligned} |\Phi_a^{(i)}\rangle &= |0\rangle^{\otimes(a-1)} |\psi\rangle^{\otimes i} |0\rangle^{\otimes(n-a-i+1)}, \\ a &= 1, \dots, N. \end{aligned}$$

Their exact Gram matrix is

$$(G_{N,i})_{ab} = r^{\min(|a-b|, i)}. \quad (3.1)$$

Define

$$f_{i,r}(\theta) = 1 - r^i + 2 \sum_{d=1}^{i-1} (r^d - r^i) \cos(d\theta). \quad (3.2)$$

3.1 Fixed-length limit

Theorem 3.1 (Fixed-length localization). *For every fixed integer $i \geq 1$ and $0 \leq r \leq 1$,*

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} P_{\text{opt}}(G_{N,i}) = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} P_{\text{SRM}}(G_{N,i}) = P_{\infty}(i, r), \quad (3.3)$$

where

$$P_{\infty}(i, r) = \left[\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{f_{i,r}(\theta)} d\theta \right]^2. \quad (3.4)$$

For fixed i and $0 < r < 1$,

$$0 \leq P_{\text{opt}}(G_{N,i}) - P_{\text{SRM}}(G_{N,i}) = O_{i,r}(N^{-1/2}). \quad (3.5)$$

Proof. Put $q = r^i$ and decompose

$$G_{N,i} = qJ_N + B_{N,i},$$

where $B_{N,i} = T_N(f_{i,r})$ has entries

$$(B_{N,i})_{ab} = \begin{cases} r^{|a-b|} - r^i, & |a-b| < i, \\ 0, & |a-b| \geq i. \end{cases}$$

Choose a local basis with $|\psi\rangle = \sqrt{r}|0\rangle + \sqrt{1-r}|1\rangle$. After removing the common all-zero component, each candidate has a basis component, with squared amplitude $(1-r)^i$, that occurs in no other candidate. Hence

$$B_{N,i} \geq (1-r)^i I_N. \quad (3.6)$$

The corresponding infinite residual convolution operator has symbol $f_{i,r}$, so (3.6), applied to arbitrarily long finitely supported vectors, implies

$$f_{i,r}(\theta) \geq (1-r)^i. \quad (3.7)$$

For $N \geq 2i$, let $\tilde{B}_{N,i}$ be the circulant matrix with the same local coefficients and set

$$C_{N,i} = r^i J_N + \tilde{B}_{N,i}.$$

Its eigenvalues away from the uniform Fourier mode are the sampled values $f_{i,r}(2\pi k/N)$; the uniform mode receives the additional positive rank-one contribution. Thus $C_{N,i}$ is a positive definite, unit-diagonal circulant Gram matrix. The matrices $B_{N,i}$ and $\tilde{B}_{N,i}$

differ only in the upper-right and lower-left wrap-around corner blocks.

To make the boundary estimate explicit, set

$$b_d = r^d - r^i,$$

$$E_{N,d} = \sum_{a=1}^d e_a e_{N-d+a}^*, \quad 1 \leq d < i.$$

Here $E_{N,d}$ is a rank- d partial permutation from the last d coordinates to the first d coordinates, and

$$\tilde{B}_{N,i} - B_{N,i} = \sum_{d=1}^{i-1} b_d (E_{N,d} + E_{N,d}^*). \quad (3.8)$$

For $N \geq 2i$, the initial and terminal coordinate subspaces in (3.8) are disjoint. Consequently $\|E_{N,d} + E_{N,d}^*\|_1 = 2d$. Moreover, the whole difference maps between the span of the first $i-1$ coordinates and the span of the last $i-1$ coordinates. The triangle inequality and this two-corner support therefore give

$$\|G_{N,i} - C_{N,i}\|_1 \leq K_{i,r} := 2 \sum_{d=1}^{i-1} d(r^d - r^i), \quad (3.9)$$

$$\text{rank}(G_{N,i} - C_{N,i}) \leq 2(i-1). \quad (3.10)$$

The Sylvester integral gives

$$\|\sqrt{G_{N,i}} - \sqrt{C_{N,i}}\|_1 \leq \frac{K_{i,r}}{2(1-r)^{i/2}} = O_{i,r}(1). \quad (3.11)$$

Because $C_{N,i}$ and $\sqrt{C_{N,i}}$ are circulant, the diagonal of $\sqrt{C_{N,i}}$ is constant. If

$$\beta_N = \frac{1}{N} \text{tr} \sqrt{C_{N,i}},$$

then the SRM value is β_N^2 . The Yuen–Kennedy–Lax dual operator

$$Y = \frac{\beta_N}{N} \sqrt{C_{N,i}}$$

is feasible because, with $S = \sqrt{C_{N,i}}$,

$$\beta_N S - S e_j e_j^* S \geq 0.$$

Indeed, since $S \succ 0$, congruence by $S^{-1/2}$ reduces this to

$$\beta_N I - S^{1/2} e_j e_j^* S^{1/2} \geq 0.$$

The rank-one term has unique nonzero eigenvalue $e_j^* S e_j = \beta_N$, because the diagonal of S is constant. Since $\text{tr} Y = \beta_N^2$, the SRM is exactly optimal for the circulant model.

Let

$$\tau_N = \|\sqrt{G_{N,i}} - \sqrt{C_{N,i}}\|_1.$$

Put $\Delta_N = \sqrt{G_{N,i}} - \sqrt{C_{N,i}}$. The canonical Gram realizations, followed by Cauchy–Schwarz and the monotonicity of Schatten norms, give the explicit chain

$$\begin{aligned} |P_{\text{opt}}(G_{N,i}) - P_{\text{opt}}(C_{N,i})| &\leq \frac{1}{N} \sum_{j=1}^N \|\Delta_N e_j\|_2 \\ &\leq \frac{1}{\sqrt{N}} \left(\sum_{j=1}^N \|\Delta_N e_j\|_2^2 \right)^{1/2} \\ &= \frac{\|\Delta_N\|_{\text{HS}}}{\sqrt{N}} \\ &\leq \frac{\|\Delta_N\|_1}{\sqrt{N}} = \frac{\tau_N}{\sqrt{N}}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.12)$$

while the SRM diagonal formula gives

$$|P_{\text{SRM}}(G_{N,i}) - P_{\text{SRM}}(C_{N,i})| \leq \frac{2\tau_N}{N}.$$

Together with (3.11), this proves (3.5). Finally, the sampled eigenvalues form a Riemann sum. The rank-one uniform-mode correction changes $N^{-1} \text{tr} \sqrt{C}$ by at most $O(N^{-1/2})$, and therefore

$$\frac{1}{N} \text{tr} \sqrt{C_{N,i}} \longrightarrow \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{f_{i,r}(\theta)} d\theta.$$

This proves (3.3)–(3.4) for $0 < r < 1$. The cases $r = 0, 1$ are handled below. $\square$

Corollary 3.2 (Residual Toeplitz family). *Fix $i \geq 1$ and $0 \leq r < 1$, put $q = r^i$, and let*

$$R_{N,i} := \frac{G_{N,i} - qJ_N}{1-q} = T_N \left(\frac{f_{i,r}}{1-r^i} \right).$$

Then $R_{N,i}$ is the Gram matrix of normalized residual states and

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} P_{\text{opt}}(R_{N,i}) = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} P_{\text{SRM}}(R_{N,i}) = \frac{P_{\infty}(i,r)}{1-r^i}. \quad (3.13)$$

Equivalently, $(1-r^i)P_{\text{opt}}(R_{N,i}) \rightarrow P_{\infty}(i,r)$, and the same statement holds with P_{SRM} .

Proof. The diagonal of $G_{N,i} - qJ_N$ is $1-q$, and (3.6) shows that it is positive definite. Thus $R_{N,i}$ is a unit-diagonal Gram matrix. Its Toeplitz symbol is $h_{i,r} = f_{i,r}/(1-r^i)$, which is bounded above and below away from zero. The one-dimensional instance of Lemma 5.1, followed by Lemma 5.2 and (2.1), gives the common limit

$$\left[\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{h_{i,r}(\theta)} d\theta \right]^2 = \frac{P_{\infty}(i,r)}{1-r^i}.$$

$\square$

3.2 Exact and special-function cases

Corollary 3.3 (One-site interval, finite size). *For $i = 1$,*

$$G_{N,1} = (1-r)I_N + rJ_N$$

is permutation invariant. Its positive square root has constant diagonal, so the preceding dual certificate proves finite-size SRM optimality. Since its eigenvalues are $1 + (N-1)r$ once and $1-r$ with multiplicity $N-1$,

$$\begin{aligned} P_{\text{opt}}(G_{N,1}) &= P_{\text{SRM}}(G_{N,1}) \\ &= \frac{[\sqrt{1+(N-1)r} + (N-1)\sqrt{1-r}]^2}{N^2}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.14)$$

In particular, $P_{\infty}(1, r) = 1 - r$.

This is the $k = 1$ specialization of the known single-anomaly result in Refs. [11, 12], after identifying their anomaly overlap parameter with $r = c^2$. We include it to show that the interval family recovers that established finite-size formula at $i = 1$, not as a new single-anomaly theorem.

Corollary 3.4 (Two-site interval). *With*

$$E(m) = \int_0^{\pi/2} \sqrt{1 - m \sin^2 u} du,$$

one has

$$P_{\infty}(2, r) = \frac{4}{\pi^2} (1-r)(1+3r) E^2\left(\frac{4r}{1+3r}\right). \quad (3.15)$$

Derivation. Equation (3.2) becomes

$$\begin{aligned} f_{2,r}(\theta) &= (1-r)(1+r+2r \cos \theta) \\ &= (1-r)(1+3r-4r \sin^2(\theta/2)). \end{aligned}$$

With $u = \theta/2$ and symmetry about $\pi/2$,

$$\begin{aligned} &\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{f_{2,r}(\theta)} d\theta \\ &= \frac{2}{\pi} \sqrt{(1-r)(1+3r)} E\left(\frac{4r}{1+3r}\right). \end{aligned}$$

Squaring proves (3.15). $\square$

3.3 Endpoint parameters

If $r = 0$, then $G_{N,i} = I_N$ and both success probabilities equal one. If $r = 1$, then $G_{N,i} = J_N$, all hypotheses represent the same ray, and both probabilities equal $1/N$. These values agree with the continuous limiting formulas. All spectral-gap arguments above are used only for $0 < r < 1$.

4 A growing known length

Define the Poisson kernel

$$g_r(\theta) = \sum_{d \in \mathbb{Z}} r^{|d|} e^{id\theta} = \frac{1-r^2}{1-2r \cos \theta + r^2}$$

and

$$p_1(r) = \left[\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{g_r(\theta)} d\theta \right]^2 = \frac{4(1-r^2)}{\pi^2} K^2(r^2), \quad (4.1)$$

where K is the complete elliptic integral of the first kind in the parameter convention and $p_1(1) = 0$ by continuity. The last equality follows from the standard Landen transformation; the integral representation is the definition used in all proofs.

Proposition 4.1 (One-change Toeplitz benchmark). *For*

$$Q_N = (r^{|a-b|})_{a,b=1}^N, \quad 0 \leq r < 1,$$

one has

$$\begin{aligned} P_{\text{opt}}(Q_N), P_{\text{SRM}}(Q_N) &\longrightarrow p_1(r), \\ \frac{1}{N} \text{tr} \sqrt{Q_N} &\longrightarrow \sqrt{p_1(r)}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.2)$$

Proof. The matrix Q_N is the compression of the one-dimensional convolution operator with kernel $r^{|d|}$, whose symbol is g_r and is bounded above and below away from zero. Lemma 5.1, with $d = 1$ and $\phi(t) = \sqrt{t}$, gives convergence in mean of the square-root diagonal to $(2\pi)^{-1} \int \sqrt{g_r} = \sqrt{p_1(r)}$. Lemma 5.2 supplies the matching minimum-error upper bound, while (2.1) supplies the lower bound and the SRM squeeze. This also recovers the benchmark of Ref. [2]. $\square$

Theorem 4.2 (Long known interval). *Let $i = i_n$ and $N_n = n - i_n + 1$. If*

$$i_n \rightarrow \infty, \quad N_n \rightarrow \infty, \quad (4.3)$$

then, for every fixed $0 \leq r \leq 1$,

$$P_{\text{opt}}(G_{N_n, i_n}), P_{\text{SRM}}(G_{N_n, i_n}) \longrightarrow p_1(r) = p_1(r^2). \quad (4.4)$$

No condition on i_n/N_n is required. The convergence is pointwise in fixed r . No finite-size rate or uniformity as $r \uparrow 1$ is claimed.

Proof. The endpoint values $r = 0, 1$ follow from the matrices described in Section 3.3. We therefore assume $0 < r < 1$ and put $q_i = r^i$. Separating the common all-zero component gives

$$|\Phi_a^{(i)}\rangle = \sqrt{q_i} |\Omega\rangle + \sqrt{1-q_i} |\xi_a^{(i)}\rangle, \quad \langle \Omega | \xi_a^{(i)} \rangle = 0.$$

The normalized residual Gram matrix is

$$(R_{N,i})_{ab} = \begin{cases} \frac{r^{|a-b|} - r^i}{1 - r^i}, & |a-b| < i, \\ 0, & |a-b| \geq i. \end{cases} \quad (4.5)$$

Its symbol

$$h_{i,r}(\theta) = 1 + 2 \sum_{d=1}^{i-1} \frac{r^d - r^i}{1 - r^i} \cos(d\theta)$$

satisfies

$$\|h_{i,r} - g_r\|_\infty \leq \frac{2(i-1)r^i}{1-r^i} + \frac{2r^i}{1-r} =: \varepsilon_i(r) \rightarrow 0. \quad (4.6)$$

Let $Q_N = (r^{|a-b|})_{a,b=1}^N$. Toeplitz compression gives

$$\|R_{N,i} - Q_N\|_{\text{op}} \leq \varepsilon_i(r). \quad (4.7)$$

Since $g_r \geq (1-r)/(1+r) > 0$, both matrices have a common positive spectral gap for large i . Lemma 2.1 therefore transfers the minimum-error optimum uniformly in N . The trace distance between each original state and its residual state is also $\sqrt{q_i} = r^{i/2}$, so

$$|P_{\text{opt}}(G_{N,i}) - P_{\text{opt}}(R_{N,i})| \leq r^{i/2}.$$

The single-change-point Toeplitz limit for Q_N therefore proves

$$P_{\text{opt}}(G_{N,i}) \rightarrow p_1(r).$$

For the SRM, the rank-one common component requires a separate trace estimate. Since

$$G_{N,i} = q_i J_N + (1 - q_i) R_{N,i},$$

operator monotonicity and the Rotfel'd trace inequality give the exact sandwich

$$\begin{aligned} \sqrt{1 - q_i} \operatorname{tr} \sqrt{R_{N,i}} &\leq \operatorname{tr} \sqrt{G_{N,i}} \\ &\leq \sqrt{1 - q_i} \operatorname{tr} \sqrt{R_{N,i}} + \sqrt{q_i N}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.8)$$

Equation (4.7), the common spectral gap, and the Toeplitz limit imply

$$\frac{1}{N} \operatorname{tr} \sqrt{R_{N,i}} \rightarrow \sqrt{p_1(r)}.$$

After dividing (4.8) by N , the remaining rank-one term is $\sqrt{q_i}/N \rightarrow 0$. Thus

$$\frac{1}{N} \operatorname{tr} \sqrt{G_{N,i}} \rightarrow \sqrt{p_1(r)}.$$

The sandwich (2.1) completes the SRM proof. $\square$

Remark 4.3 (An exact finite-size regime). If $i \geq N-1$, then $\min(|a-b|, i) = |a-b|$ for every matrix entry, and hence

$$G_{N,i} = Q_N$$

exactly. The approximation in Theorem 4.2 is needed only when $i < N-1$.

5 Unknown interval length

Let

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{I}_n &= \{[a, b] : 1 \leq a \leq b \leq n\}, \\ M_n &= |\mathcal{I}_n| = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}, \end{aligned}$$

and equip $\mathcal{I}_n$ with the uniform prior $1/M_n$. This is uniform over intervals, not over lengths. If $L = |I|$, the induced marginal is

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr\{L = \ell\} &= \frac{n - \ell + 1}{M_n} \\ &= \frac{2(n - \ell + 1)}{n(n+1)}, \quad 1 \leq \ell \leq n. \end{aligned} \quad (5.1)$$

Conditionally on $L = \ell$, the starting point is uniform over its $n - \ell + 1$ admissible values. Consequently $\mathbb{E}L = (n+2)/3$, and L/n converges to the triangular density $2(1-x)$ on $0 < x < 1$. Thus the prior favors shorter lengths, but its typical interval still has order- n length. The candidate indexed by $I = [a, b]$ has $|\psi\rangle$ on I and $|0\rangle$ elsewhere. Its exact Gram kernel is

$$G_{I,J}^{(n)} = c^{|I \triangle J|}. \quad (5.2)$$

Theorem 5.3 is therefore a Bayes law for the uniform-over-intervals prior in (5.1), not a prior-independent law for every unknown-length model. Alternative priors can, for example, retain nonvanishing mass on bounded or logarithmically short intervals, for which the reduction below need not apply.

For intersecting intervals,

$$|I \triangle J| = |a - a'| + |b - b'|. \quad (5.3)$$

For disjoint intervals, assume without loss of generality that $b < a'$ and define the separating gap by

$$g(I, J) := a' - b - 1 \geq 0.$$

Then the exact identity is

$$|a - a'| + |b - b'| = |I \triangle J| + 2g(I, J). \quad (5.4)$$

Thus (5.3) still holds for adjacent intervals, where $g(I, J) = 0$, but fails by twice the separating gap when

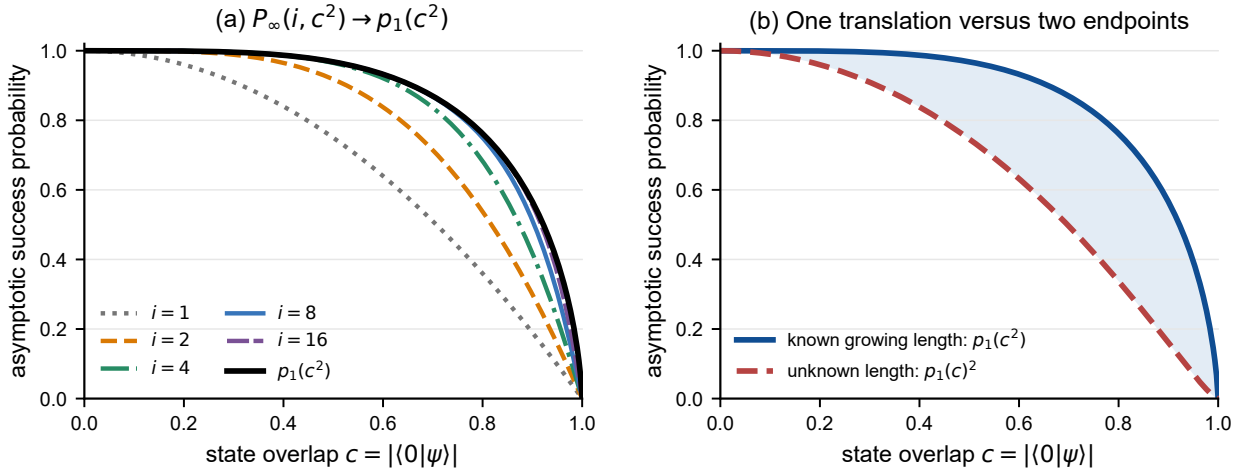


Figure 2: **Hierarchy of analytic localization limits.** (a) The fixed-length Toeplitz integral $P_\infty(i, c^2)$ approaches the long-known-interval law $p_1(c^2)$ as i grows. The $i = 2$ curve is equivalently given by the complete-elliptic-integral expression in Corollary 3.4. (b) An unknown interval instead yields $p_1(c)^2$. The light-blue shaded band is the pointwise difference $p_1(c^2) - p_1(c)^2$ between the two limiting laws; it is not a confidence band, a numerical error estimate, or a same-prior ignorance penalty. The one-translation/two-endpoint language is a structural interpretation; the second law follows from the two-dimensional Følner limit and the separable comparison symbol.

$g(I, J) > 0$. The exact physical kernel is therefore not globally a two-dimensional Toeplitz kernel.

Classical multilevel Szegő theorems describe spectral averages for genuine multilevel Toeplitz compressions [19, 20]. Here the triangular endpoint sets and, more importantly, the non-Toeplitz physical kernel require the following local-diagonal Følner statement together with a separate perturbative transfer back to $G^{(n)}$.

5.1 A Følner functional-calculus lemma

Lemma 5.1 (Local diagonal Følner limit). *Let $k \in \ell^1(\mathbb{Z}^d)$ satisfy $k(-u) = k(u)$, let A be convolution by k on $\ell^2(\mathbb{Z}^d)$, and suppose its Fourier symbol satisfies*

$$0 < \mu \leq F(\theta) \leq L < \infty$$

almost everywhere. If $\Lambda_n \subset \mathbb{Z}^d$ is any finite Følner sequence and $A_n = P_n A P_n|_{\ell^2(\Lambda_n)}$, then for every continuous $\phi : [\mu, L] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$,

$$\frac{1}{|\Lambda_n|} \sum_{x \in \Lambda_n} |\langle \delta_x, \phi(A_n) \delta_x \rangle - a_\phi| \rightarrow 0, \quad (5.5)$$

where

$$a_\phi = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^d} \int_{[0, 2\pi]^d} \phi(F(\theta)) d\theta.$$

Proof. Since A has spectrum in $[\mu, L]$, the same is true of every compression A_n . Fix $\varepsilon > 0$ and put $\eta = \varepsilon/8$. By the Weierstrass theorem, applied to the real and imaginary parts if necessary, choose a polynomial

$$p(t) = \sum_{m=0}^s a_m t^m \quad \text{such that} \quad \sup_{t \in [\mu, L]} |\phi(t) - p(t)| < \eta.$$

Let $k_R = k \mathbf{1}_{\{\|u\|_\infty \leq R\}}$, let A_R be convolution by k_R , and set $A_{R,n} = P_n A_R P_n|_{\ell^2(\Lambda_n)}$. Young's inequality gives

$$\|A - A_R\|_{\text{op}}, \|A_n - A_{R,n}\|_{\text{op}} \leq \|k - k_R\|_{\ell^1}. \quad (5.6)$$

Choose R so large that the right-hand side of (5.6) is at most 1 and

$$C_p \|k - k_R\|_{\ell^1} < \eta, \quad C_p := \sum_{m=1}^s m |a_m| (L+1)^{m-1},$$

where the second condition is void if $C_p = 0$. The telescoping identity for $X^m - Y^m$, together with $\|A\|, \|A_n\| \leq L$ and $\|A_R\|, \|A_{R,n}\| \leq L+1$, then yields

$$\|p(A) - p(A_R)\|_{\text{op}}, \|p(A_n) - p(A_{R,n})\|_{\text{op}} < \eta. \quad (5.7)$$

Define

$$Q_t = \{h \in \mathbb{Z}^d : \|h\|_\infty \leq t\}$$

and the sR -interior and boundary by

$$\begin{aligned} \Lambda_n^{\circ, sR} &= \{x \in \Lambda_n : x + Q_{sR} \subseteq \Lambda_n\}, \\ \partial_{sR} \Lambda_n &= \Lambda_n \setminus \Lambda_n^{\circ, sR}. \end{aligned}$$

Every length- $m \leq s$ path generated by the range- R kernel and starting at $x \in \Lambda_n^{\circ, sR}$ stays in Λ_n . Therefore

$$\langle \delta_x, p(A_{R,n}) \delta_x \rangle = \langle \delta_0, p(A_R) \delta_0 \rangle, \quad x \in \Lambda_n^{\circ, sR}. \quad (5.8)$$

The radius here is sR , not R . Moreover,

$$\partial_{sR} \Lambda_n \subseteq \bigcup_{\|h\|_\infty \leq sR} (\Lambda_n \setminus (\Lambda_n - h)). \quad (5.9)$$

The union is finite and each summand has $o(|\Lambda_n|)$ elements by the Følner property. Hence $|\partial_{sR} \Lambda_n|/|\Lambda_n| \rightarrow 0$. With $K_p = \sup_{|t| \leq L+1} |p(t)|$, define

$$d_{n,R,p}(x) := |\langle \delta_x, p(A_{R,n}) \delta_x \rangle - \langle \delta_0, p(A_R) \delta_0 \rangle|, \\ D_{n,R,p} := \frac{1}{|\Lambda_n|} \sum_{x \in \Lambda_n} d_{n,R,p}(x).$$

Equations (5.8)–(5.9) give

$$D_{n,R,p} \leq 2K_p \frac{|\partial_{sR} \Lambda_n|}{|\Lambda_n|} \rightarrow 0. \quad (5.10)$$

Finally, the spectral theorem and Fourier transformation identify

$$\langle \delta_0, \phi(A) \delta_0 \rangle = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^d} \int_{[0, 2\pi]^d} \phi(F(\theta)) d\theta = a_\phi.$$

Put

$$D_n^\phi := \frac{1}{|\Lambda_n|} \sum_{x \in \Lambda_n} |\langle \delta_x, \phi(A_n) \delta_x \rangle - a_\phi|.$$

For all sufficiently large n , functional calculus, (5.7), and (5.10) now give the single uniform error chain

$$D_n^\phi \leq \|\phi(A_n) - p(A_n)\|_{\text{op}} \\ + \|p(A_n) - p(A_{R,n})\|_{\text{op}} \\ + D_{n,R,p} \\ + \|p(A_R) - p(A)\|_{\text{op}} \\ + \|p(A) - \phi(A)\|_{\text{op}} \\ < 4\eta + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon.$$

This proves (5.5). $\square$

Lemma 5.2 (Gram upper bound for equiprobable pure states). *Let G be an $M \times M$ positive semidefinite Gram matrix with unit diagonal. Set*

$$d_j = (\sqrt{G})_{jj}, \quad q_j = \frac{d_j}{\text{tr} \sqrt{G}}, \quad u_j = \frac{1}{M}.$$

Then

$$\left(\frac{\text{tr} \sqrt{G}}{M} \right)^2 \leq P_{\text{opt}}(G) \\ \leq \left(\frac{\text{tr} \sqrt{G}}{M} \right)^2 + \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}(G)} \|q - u\|_1. \quad (5.11)$$

Proof. The lower bound is (2.1). For $G \succ 0$, the upper bound is Theorem 1 of Ref. [2], rewritten in our normalization so that no prior-weight or hypothesis-count factor is implicit. That theorem assumes linearly independent states, equivalently a positive definite Gram matrix. For singular G , apply it to

$$G_\varepsilon = (1 - \varepsilon)G + \varepsilon I_M, \quad 0 < \varepsilon < 1.$$

Each G_ε is positive definite and has unit diagonal. As $\varepsilon \downarrow 0$, the positive square root, its trace and diagonal, $\lambda_{\max}$, and hence q all converge to their counterparts for G . Lemma 2.1 also gives $P_{\text{opt}}(G_\varepsilon) \rightarrow P_{\text{opt}}(G)$. Passing to the limit proves the singular case. $\square$

5.2 The two-endpoint law

Theorem 5.3 (Unknown-length interval). *Under the uniform prior on $\mathcal{I}_n$,*

$$P_{\text{opt}}(G^{(n)}), P_{\text{SRM}}(G^{(n)}) \rightarrow p_1(c)^2 \quad (5.12)$$

for every fixed $0 \leq c \leq 1$. The convergence is pointwise in fixed c . No finite-size rate or uniformity as $c \uparrow 1$ is claimed.

Proof. For $c = 0$, the hypotheses are orthogonal, whereas for $c = 1$ they are identical; both cases agree with the stated limit. Assume henceforth that $0 < c < 1$, and choose

$$L_n = \lceil \gamma \log n \rceil, \quad \gamma > |\log c|^{-1},$$

and retain only

$$\mathcal{B}_n = \{I \in \mathcal{I}_n : |I| \geq L_n\}.$$

The deleted prior mass is

$$\varepsilon_n = 1 - \frac{|\mathcal{B}_n|}{M_n} = O\left(\frac{\log n}{n}\right) \rightarrow 0. \quad (5.13)$$

On $\mathcal{B}_n$, define the comparison kernel

$$H_{I,J}^{(n)} = c^{|a-a'|+|b-b'|}. \quad (5.14)$$

It is the compression of the positive convolution kernel $c^{|u|+|v|}$. The two kernels agree for intersecting intervals. For disjoint intervals,

$$|G_{I,J} - H_{I,J}| \leq c^{|I|+|J|} \leq c^{2L_n}.$$

Consequently,

$$\|G_{\mathcal{B}_n} - H_{\mathcal{B}_n}\|_{\text{op}} \leq |\mathcal{B}_n| c^{2L_n} = o(1). \quad (5.15)$$

Lemma 2.1 transfers both success probabilities between these long-interval kernels.

We verify rather than assume the Følner property. Under the endpoint identification $I = [a, b] \leftrightarrow (a, b)$,

$$\mathcal{B}_n = \{(a, b) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 : a \geq 1, b \leq n, b - a \geq L_n - 1\},$$

and

$$|\mathcal{B}_n| = \frac{(n - L_n + 1)(n - L_n + 2)}{2} \sim \frac{n^2}{2}. \quad (5.16)$$

Fix $h = (u, v) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ and put $H = \|h\|_\infty$. If the indicators of $\mathcal{B}_n$ at $x = (a, b)$ and $x + h$ differ, at least one of the three affine inequalities defining $\mathcal{B}_n$ changes truth value. Such an x lies in a strip of respectively $|u|$, $|v|$, or $|v - u|$ lattice layers adjacent to $a = 1$, $b = n$, or $b - a = L_n - 1$. Because either x or $x + h$ belongs to $\mathcal{B}_n$, each layer contains at most $n + 2H + 1$ relevant points. Put $C_h = |u| + |v| + |v - u|$. Therefore

$$\frac{|(\mathcal{B}_n - h) \triangle \mathcal{B}_n|}{|\mathcal{B}_n|} \leq \frac{C_h(n + 2H + 1)}{|\mathcal{B}_n|} \rightarrow 0, \quad (5.17)$$

where (5.16) and $L_n = O(\log n) = o(n)$ were used. Thus $(\mathcal{B}_n)$ is a Følner sequence in $\mathbb{Z}^2$. The comparison convolution symbol is

$$F_c(\theta_1, \theta_2) = g_c(\theta_1)g_c(\theta_2),$$

with a uniform positive lower bound. Lemma 5.1 with $\phi(t) = \sqrt{t}$ yields

$$\frac{1}{|\mathcal{B}_n|} \sum_{I \in \mathcal{B}_n} |(\sqrt{H_{\mathcal{B}_n}})_{II} - \alpha_c| \rightarrow 0, \quad (5.18)$$

where separability gives

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha_c &= \frac{1}{(2\pi)^2} \iint \sqrt{F_c} \\ &= \left[\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{g_c(\theta)} d\theta \right]^2 = p_1(c). \end{aligned} \quad (5.19)$$

The lower bound (2.1) therefore converges to α_c^2 . For the matching upper bound, put

$$q_I = \frac{(\sqrt{H})_{II}}{\text{tr } \sqrt{H}}, \quad u_I = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{B}_n|}.$$

Equation (5.18) implies $\|q - u\|_1 \rightarrow 0$, and

$$\lambda_{\max}(H_{\mathcal{B}_n}) \leq \|F_c\|_\infty = \left(\frac{1+c}{1-c} \right)^2.$$

Lemma 5.2 gives

$$P_{\text{opt}}(H_{\mathcal{B}_n}) \leq \left(\frac{\text{tr } \sqrt{H}}{|\mathcal{B}_n|} \right)^2 + \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}(H)} \|q - u\|_1,$$

so the optimum tends to $\alpha_c^2 = p_1(c)^2$. Equation (5.18) also implies convergence of the average squared diagonal and hence of the SRM.

We now pass from the long-interval subfamily back to all intervals. Deleting prior mass ε_n changes the optimum by at most ε_n , which already proves the full-family optimal limit. The SRM needs an additional trace comparison. Set

$$t_n = \frac{\text{tr } \sqrt{G^{(n)}}}{M_n}.$$

Since $G_{\mathcal{B}_n}$ is a principal submatrix, eigenvalue interlacing gives

$$t_n \geq \frac{|\mathcal{B}_n|}{M_n} \frac{\text{tr } \sqrt{G_{\mathcal{B}_n}}}{|\mathcal{B}_n|}. \quad (5.20)$$

The factor $|\mathcal{B}_n|/M_n = 1 - \varepsilon_n$ is essential. Equations (5.15)–(5.19) show that the right-hand side tends to α_c , whereas $t_n^2 \leq P_{\text{opt}}(G^{(n)})$ gives the reverse limsup. Thus $t_n \rightarrow \alpha_c$, and

$$t_n^2 \leq P_{\text{SRM}}(G^{(n)}) \leq P_{\text{opt}}(G^{(n)})$$

proves the original, untruncated SRM limit. $\square$

6 Joint detection and exact localization

Add the no-anomaly state

$$|\Omega\rangle = |0\rangle^{\otimes n}$$

with fixed prior $\pi_0 \in (0, 1)$. The task is successful only if the measurement reports H_0 when no anomaly is present, or reports the exact anomalous interval otherwise.

Theorem 6.1 (Fixed known length with no-anomaly prior). *For fixed i ,*

$$P_{\text{joint}}^*(N, i, r, \pi_0) \rightarrow \pi_0 + (1 - \pi_0)P_\infty(i, r). \quad (6.1)$$

If $i = i_n \rightarrow \infty$ and $N_n \rightarrow \infty$, then

$$P_{\text{joint}}^* \rightarrow \pi_0 + (1 - \pi_0)p_1(c^2). \quad (6.2)$$

Proof. If $r = 1$, every anomalous candidate equals $|\Omega\rangle$. The $N + 1$ labels are therefore represented by one physical state, with label priors π_0 and $(1 - \pi_0)/N$. Hence, exactly at finite N ,

$$P_{\text{joint}}^*(N, i, 1, \pi_0) = \max \left\{ \pi_0, \frac{1 - \pi_0}{N} \right\} \rightarrow \pi_0. \quad (6.3)$$

This agrees with (6.1) because $P_\infty(i, 1) = 0$. Assume henceforth that $0 \leq r < 1$. Put $q = r^i$ and use

$$|\Phi_a^{(i)}\rangle = \sqrt{q}|\Omega\rangle + \sqrt{1-q}|\xi_a^{(i)}\rangle.$$

If P_G^* and P_R^* are the equal-prior localization optima for the original and residual ensembles, respectively, then the explicit measurement that assigns $|\Omega\rangle$ to H_0 and uses an optimal residual measurement on $|\Omega\rangle^\perp$ gives

$$\pi_0 + (1 - \pi_0)(1 - q)P_R^* \leq P_{\text{joint}}^*.$$

Conversely, the no-anomaly contribution is at most π_0 , and completing the anomalous sub-POVM can only improve its conditional localization score, so

$$P_{\text{joint}}^* \leq \pi_0 + (1 - \pi_0)P_G^*.$$

For fixed i , Corollary 3.2 gives $(1 - r^i)P_R^* \rightarrow P_\infty(i, r)$, and the two bounds prove (6.1). In the growing-length regime, $|P_G^* - P_R^*| \leq r^{i/2}$ and $q \rightarrow 0$; Theorem 4.2 then proves (6.2). At $r = 0$, all $N + 1$ states are mutually orthogonal and $P_{\text{joint}}^* = 1$, also in agreement with both displayed limits. $\square$

Theorem 6.2 (Unknown length with no-anomaly prior). *Under the uniform prior over all nonempty intervals,*

$$P_{\text{joint}}^*(n, c, \pi_0) \rightarrow \pi_0 + (1 - \pi_0)p_1(c)^2. \quad (6.4)$$

Proof. Assume $0 < c < 1$ and use the long-interval family $\mathcal{B}_n$ from Theorem 5.3. For $I \in \mathcal{B}_n$, put

$$s_I = \langle \Omega | \Phi_I \rangle = c^{|I|} \leq c^{L_n} =: \eta_n \rightarrow 0$$

and

$$|\xi_I\rangle = \frac{|\Phi_I\rangle - s_I|\Omega\rangle}{\sqrt{1 - s_I^2}}.$$

To make the conditioning explicit, define the full-family anomalous localization optimum

$$P_{G,n}^{\text{all}} := \max_{\{M_I\}_{I \in \mathcal{I}_n}} \frac{1}{M_n} \sum_{I \in \mathcal{I}_n} \langle \Phi_I | M_I | \Phi_I \rangle = P_{\text{opt}}(G^{(n)}),$$

and define the two equal-prior optima on the retained family by

$$P_{G,n}^{\mathcal{B}} := \max_{\{M_I\}_{I \in \mathcal{B}_n}} \frac{1}{|\mathcal{B}_n|} \sum_{I \in \mathcal{B}_n} \langle \Phi_I | M_I | \Phi_I \rangle,$$

$$P_{R,n}^{\mathcal{B}} := \max_{\{M_I\}_{I \in \mathcal{B}_n}} \frac{1}{|\mathcal{B}_n|} \sum_{I \in \mathcal{B}_n} \langle \xi_I | M_I | \xi_I \rangle.$$

In each maximization the operators form a POVM on the support of the corresponding conditional ensemble, completed arbitrarily on its orthogonal complement. These are conditional localization probabilities: the factors $1 - \pi_0$ and $1 - \varepsilon_n$ are not included in their definitions. The pure-state trace distance gives the uniform comparison

$$|P_{R,n}^{\mathcal{B}} - P_{G,n}^{\mathcal{B}}| \leq \eta_n.$$

Use the optimal residual POVM for the long intervals in $|\Omega\rangle^\perp$, assign zero operators to deleted short intervals, and assign the remaining operator to H_0 . With $\varepsilon_n = 1 - |\mathcal{B}_n|/M_n$, this gives

$$P_{\text{joint}}^* \geq \pi_0 + (1 - \pi_0)(1 - \varepsilon_n)(1 - \eta_n^2)(P_{G,n}^{\mathcal{B}} - \eta_n).$$

The universal upper bound is

$$P_{\text{joint}}^* \leq \pi_0 + (1 - \pi_0)P_{G,n}^{\text{all}}.$$

Theorem 5.3 and $\varepsilon_n, \eta_n \rightarrow 0$ make the bounds coincide. If $c = 0$, all hypotheses are mutually orthogonal and the success probability is one. If $c = 1$, all hypotheses are identical and the optimum is $\max\{\pi_0, (1 - \pi_0)/M_n\} \rightarrow \pi_0$. $\square$

7 Numerical certification

The numerical calculations verify the finite-size Gram matrices and show how the asymptotic regimes are approached. None of the proofs relies on numerical evidence.

For small unknown-length instances, we solve the minimum-error problem in canonical Gram coordinates with both primal and dual semidefinite programs. The certification data cover $n = 3, \dots, 7$ and

$$c \in \{0.3, 0.6, 0.8, 0.9, 0.95, 0.99\}.$$

Raw solver objectives are retained as diagnostics but are not used directly as bounds. Let ρ_j denote the prior-weighted canonical states on their d_{supp} -dimensional support. For a numerical dual matrix Y , set

$$\delta_D = \max_j \max\{0, -\lambda_{\min}(Y - \rho_j)\}$$

and add the recorded scale-aware roundoff margin $\zeta_D > 0$. Then

$$Y_{\text{safe}} = Y + (\delta_D + \zeta_D)I, \quad U_{\text{safe}} = \text{tr } Y_{\text{safe}} \quad (7.1)$$

is rechecked against every dual PSD constraint and supplies a feasible upper bound.

For the primal matrices, project each row M_j onto the PSD cone, write the result as $M_j^+ = B_j B_j^*$, and put $S = \sum_j M_j^+$. The normalized factors $S^{-1/2} B_j$

give PSD operators summing to the identity in exact arithmetic. In floating point, the implementation additionally contracts their sum T by

$$\gamma = (\max\{1, \lambda_{\max}(T)\} + \zeta_P)^{-1}$$

and assigns the PSD remainder $I - \gamma T$ to one outcome. The resulting POVM $\{\widehat{M}_j\}$ is rechecked and gives

$$L_{\text{safe}} = \sum_j \text{tr}(\rho_j \widehat{M}_j), \quad L_{\text{safe}} \leq P_{\text{opt}} \leq U_{\text{safe}}. \quad (7.2)$$

Across the 30 unknown-length cases, the largest raw absolute primal–dual gap is 6.782×10^{-9} , while the largest postprocessed feasible interval width $U_{\text{safe}} - L_{\text{safe}}$ is 8.854×10^{-9} . The largest safe completeness residual is 1.38×10^{-15} , and every rechecked safe primal and dual PSD violation is zero. The smallest safe primal eigenvalue and dual slack eigenvalue are respectively 3.4103×10^{-13} and 3.4102×10^{-13} . Full dense physical-Gram SRM computations for the single-interval model extend to $n = 50$, with candidate count $M_n = 1275$, over

$$c \in \{0.5, 0.8, 0.9, 0.95, 0.99\}.$$

High-overlap cases converge slowly. The correlation length

$$\xi(c) = |\log c|^{-1}$$

is approximately 99.5 at $c = 0.99$, so even $n = 50$ has $n/\xi \approx 0.503$. The corresponding finite-size deviations should not be interpreted as asymptotic counterexamples.

The accompanying reproducibility package records the commands, package versions, file hashes, solver residuals, and data files. The environment is pinned to Python 3.12 and fixed versions of NumPy, SciPy, Matplotlib, CVXPY, Clarabel, and SCS; the reported clean-environment rerun used Python 3.12.10.

8 Discussion and limitations

Known and unknown lengths produce different analytic laws. A long known interval is indexed by one translation coordinate. Moving it by one site changes two local factors, hence the elementary kernel parameter is c^2 and the limit is $p_1(c^2)$. An unknown interval is indexed by two endpoints. In the long intersecting regime, the symmetric-difference distance separates into the ℓ^1 distance of these endpoints; each endpoint contributes a kernel with parameter c . The normalized square-root trace is therefore $p_1(c)$, and the success probability is $p_1(c)^2$. This factorized law depends on the uniform-over-intervals prior: it should not be read as a universal penalty for every prior on an unknown duration, nor as a

same-prior value-of-information comparison with the known-length model.

For fixed known length, Theorem 3.1 proves the rigorous rate $P_{\text{opt}} - P_{\text{SRM}} = O_{i,r}(N^{-1/2})$. Exploratory finite-size calculations in some fixed-length parameter ranges are consistent with an N^{-1} decay, but the available certified sizes do not establish a uniform exponent. Determining whether the wrap-around boundary perturbation can be exploited to prove $O_{i,r}(N^{-1})$, or an asymptotic expansion with a nonzero N^{-1} coefficient, remains an open problem. By contrast, Theorems 4.2 and 5.3 are qualitative fixed-overlap limits: their proofs give neither a finite-size rate nor bounds uniform in a local regime $c = c_n \uparrow 1$.

The theorems benchmark arbitrary collective POVMs; they do not provide an efficient physical implementation of the optimum measurement. Nor do the known collective advantages for permanent changes establish an advantage for this returning-interval prior: a matched local or sequential baseline remains an open operational comparison. The results also rely on a known pure anomalous state, a fixed overlap c , and uniform priors. In particular, the analysis does not cover a local asymptotic regime $c = c_n \rightarrow 1$, unknown or mixed anomalous states, minimax priors, restricted local measurements, or a growing number of disjoint intervals. Each extension changes either the hypothesis geometry or the admissible measurement class and requires a separate analysis.

9 Conclusion

A returning quantum change retains enough translation structure for an exact asymptotic analysis. With fixed known length, the localization probability is a Toeplitz square-root integral; a growing known length gives the single-change law $p_1(c^2)$, whereas an unknown length gives the two-endpoint law $p_1(c)^2$. The SRM reaches the global minimum-error limit in all three regimes. A no-change hypothesis with fixed prior adds its Bayes contribution without altering the conditional localization law. Thus the contiguity constraint turns a general quantum multiple-hypothesis problem into tractable one- and two-dimensional spectral limits.

Data and code availability

This work is theoretical and generated no experimental data. All code and numerical data required to reproduce the results are available at <https://github.com/chenxu8817-cyber/quantum-change-intervals>. The immutable version corresponding to this manuscript is GitHub release [v1.0.0-paper1](#). An archival DOI will be added if that release is deposited in a permanent repository.

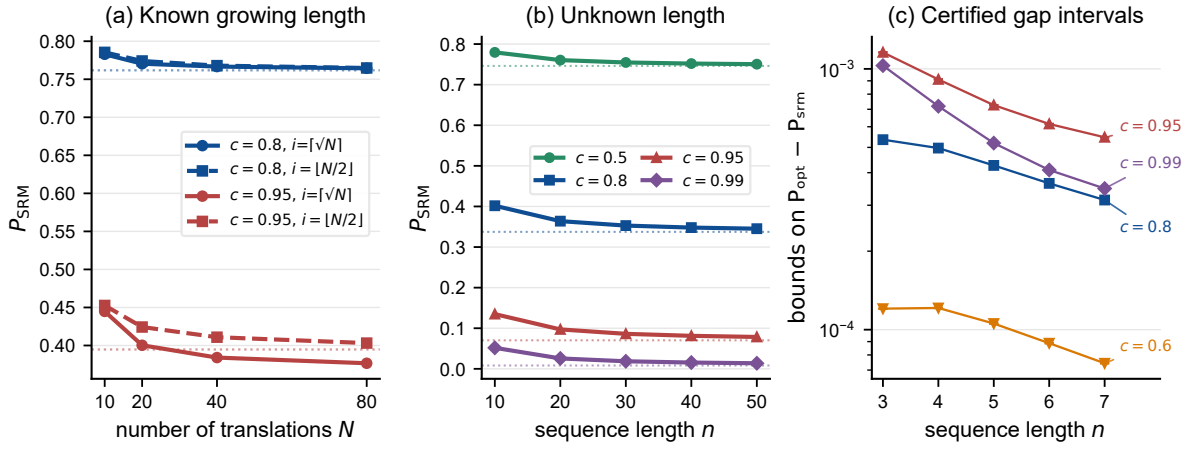


Figure 3: **Finite-size convergence and certified SRM-gap intervals.** (a) SRM success for $i = \lceil \sqrt{N} \rceil$ and $i = \lfloor N/2 \rfloor$; dotted horizontal lines are $p_1(c^2)$. (b) Full dense physical-Gram SRM values through $n = 50$; dotted lines are $p_1(c)^2$, with high-overlap curves retained as stress tests. (c) Postprocessed feasible brackets: $L_{\text{safe}} - P_{\text{SRM}} \leq P_{\text{opt}} - P_{\text{SRM}} \leq U_{\text{safe}} - P_{\text{SRM}}$ for $n \leq 7$. Plotting symbols mark only the midpoint of each displayed bracket, not an estimate of $P_{\text{opt}} - P_{\text{SRM}}$; error bars are often smaller than the symbols.

Author contributions

Xu Chen: Conceptualization; development of the physical model; formal analysis; mathematical derivation and proof of the theorems.

Xue Ma: Numerical computation; software implementation; generation of numerical data; data visualization and figure preparation.

Both authors contributed to the interpretation of the results, writing, and revision of the manuscript.

AI-assisted tools

The authors used OpenAI Codex as an assistive tool for literature discovery and bibliographic checking, LaTeX formatting, code and numerical cross-checks. The authors independently verified every cited source, theorem, derivation, numerical output, figure, and final statement and take full responsibility for the work.

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Competing interests

The authors declare no competing interests.

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